



Soul Food Holiday

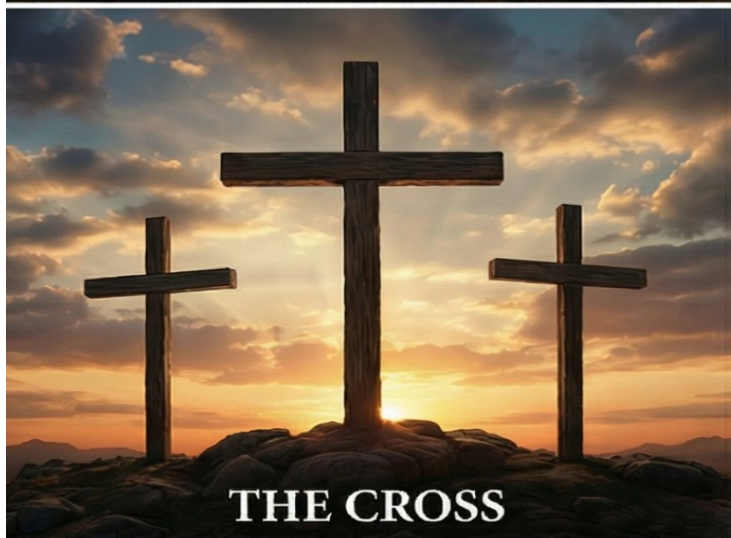
Youth Edition



THE COVENANT



THE CRADLE



THE CROSS



THE COMFORTER

The 4Cs of Christianity
Truth Served, Daily

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES

Holiday Series

Youth Edition

Theme:

4 Cs of Christianity

The Covenant, The Cradle, The Cross, and The Comforter

“...I will in no way leave you, neither will I in any way forsake you.”

— Hebrews 13:5b (WEB)

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Disclaimer

This book is designed as a Bible study and devotional resource. It is not intended to replace professional counseling, pastoral covering, medical care, or legal/financial advice. Readers are encouraged to seek appropriate professional help when needed and to remain connected to a Bible-believing local church.

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DEDICATION

This work is dedicated first and foremost to the Lord Jesus Christ, the Living Word and true Bread of Life. May every page point back to Him.

To every hungry heart that has ever sat in a pew, at a kitchen table, on a lunch break, or in a quiet corner whispering, “Lord, I want to understand Your Word, but I don’t know where to start”—these lessons were written with you in mind. You are not invisible to God, and you are not too late for His promises.

To the intercessors, pastors, teachers, and destiny helpers who labor in prayer and service behind the scenes: your obedience, your “yes,” and your unseen sacrifices are the soil this work has grown from. May God reward you in ways no book could ever fully acknowledge.

And to every believer who has ever felt like “leftovers on the table of life,” may you discover through these pages that in God’s Kingdom you are never an afterthought. You are the guest of honor at a table He prepared just for you.

With love and gratitude,

Dr. Shefa “Dee” Brown

Creator, SOFU Bible Study Series

QUICK START FOR LEADERS

Who this is for:

Pastors, ministers, small group leaders, Sunday school teachers, and facilitators using the Soul Food Series in any gathering (church, home, online, or community setting).

Session Length & Rhythm

- Recommended session time: 60–75 minutes
- Ideal pace: 1 lesson per week (or biweekly for deeper processing)
- Group size: 4–15 people works best.

Basic Flow for Each Lesson

1. Welcome & Prayer (5–10 min)
2. Appetizer (10–15 min)
3. Main Course: Bites + YOUTH (30–35 min)
4. Dessert & To-Go Box (10–15 min)
5. Closing Prayer (5 min)

Tips for Leading Well

- Create a safe space; remind the group that what is shared stays in the group (w/ appropriate exceptions for safety).
- Honor time by starting and ending close to schedule.
- Let the Holy Spirit lead; the questions are a guide, not a cage.
- Model honesty and vulnerability.
- Invite participation, not performance.

Using Activities & Games

Use Trivia Mix-Up (Millionaire-style) and Tricky Testaments (Jeopardy-style) as openers to review the previous lesson or as closers to reinforce the current one. Let youth or emerging leaders help read questions, track scores, or lead a round to build ownership and confidence.

Before Each Session

- Read the Background Text and lesson in advance.
- (Optional) Play the audio companion track.
- Pray for wisdom, discernment, and sensitivity.
- Ask God who might need extra encouragement that day.

**You don't have to be a Bible scholar to lead. You just have to be willing, teachable, and available.
God will take care of the rest.**

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Holiday Youth Introduction

Holidays can be loud, busy, and emotional all at once. Some people are celebrating; others are grieving; some are just tired. In the middle of all of that, God is still speaking.

This Holiday Edition walks through four “Cs”:

- Covenant – God makes promises and keeps them.
- Cradle – Jesus stepped into our world as a real child, in real time, for real people.
- Cross – Salvation isn’t a vague idea; it was paid for with a real sacrifice.
- Comforter – The Holy Spirit stays with us when the lights, music, and crowds fade.

Then we close with two bonus lessons:

- The Names of God – understanding how His names reveal His character.
- Times & Seasons – seeing how God uses patterns, numbers, and seasons to teach us.

As you work through these lessons, be honest with God and honest with yourself. Use the check-in YES/NO prompts, the reflection questions, and the notes pages to process where you really are with Him this season.

Lesson 1 — The Covenant

God Keeps His Promises

Theme: The Promise Still Stands

Background Text: Genesis 12:1–3; Gen 15:5–6; Jer 31:31–34; Luke 1:67–75

Key Verse: 2 Corinthians 1:20 (WEB)

“For however many are the promises of God, in him is the ‘Yes.’ Therefore also through him is the ‘Amen,’ to the glory of God through us.”

Appetizer — Leaving with Promise, Gen 12:1–3 (WEB, paraphrased)

“Now Yahweh said to Abram, ‘Leave your country... and I will make of you a great nation... and in you all the families of the earth will be blessed.’”

God initiated the covenant—not because Abram was perfect, but because God desired relationship and redemption. When God speaks a promise, He is not guessing. He is committing.

YOUTH (Youth Reflection Thought):

Where in your life have you seen God make the first move toward you?

Check-in (YES / NO):

Do you believe God can keep His promise even when you don’t see how? YES / NO

Main Course

Bite 1 — God Starts the Story, Gen 15:5–6

“Yahweh brought him outside, and said, ‘Look now toward the sky... so shall your offspring be.’ Abram believed Yahweh...”

God’s promises are built on His character, not human perfection. Even when Abram wrestled with doubts, God remained committed. The Covenant says: “My Word is stronger than your weakness.”

Youth Reflection:

Where do you need to swap doubt for trust this week?

Bite 2 — The Covenant Expands, Jer 31:31

“Behold, the days come,” says Yahweh, “that I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel, and with the house of Judah,

This prophecy points to the New Covenant—God no longer writing on stone, there are times when God will add-on or sweeten his plan for you.

Youth Reflection:

What is one habit, attitude, or decision where you need God to write His truth on your heart?

Bite 3 — The Legacy, the Laugh, and the Life, Gen 17:5,17; Gen 18:2,14

(WEB): ^{17:5}Your name will no more be called Abram, but your name will be Abraham; for I have made you the father of a multitude of nations. ¹⁷Then Abraham fell on his face, and laughed, and said in his heart, “Will a child be born to him who is one hundred years old? Will Sarah, who is ninety years old, give birth?” ^{18:2}Sarah laughed within herself, saying, “After I have grown old will I have pleasure, my lord being old also?” ¹⁴Is anything too hard for Yahweh? At the set time I will return to you, when the season comes around, and Sarah will have a son.”

Have you ever asked or was promised something, and it seems like although a lot of time has passed and you have waited (for what feels like an eternity) you are no closer to that thing, than when the statement was first made? It’s frustrating and is easy to doubt and sometimes the people who are there to help you, just complicate things even further! This is kinda of what Abraham was going through. He left Ur or his homeland at about 75 years old...and now he’s 100. Even in modern medicine how many stories do you hear of women over 70 having kids? This was a miracle loading and the conditions had to be pushed to the limits so the EXTRA-ordinary could happen!

Youth Reflection

Take a poll of people you respect or admire that have faith, (ask at least 3 people) ask them “Have they ever waited as long as Abraham or can they recall a time (testimony) when God said, “not no but rather not now” and provided them an added blessing?”

Bite 4 — Promise Fulfilled in Christ, Matt 1:1; Gal 3:16

^{1:1} The book of the genealogy of Jesus Christ,^[a] the son of David, the son of Abraham.

^{3:16} Now the promises were spoken to Abraham and to his seed.

Jesus didn't show up randomly. His birth is the fulfillment of a promise God made generations earlier. Christmas is a reminder that God keeps His Word—on time and on purpose.

When God has spoken a promise into your life, you may not always see all of the rewards of being faithful to Him but know that He is faithful to what He said about you! (Generational blessings)

Youth Reflection:

When you feel like God is “late,” what helps you remember He is still faithful?

Dessert — Yes and Amen, 2 Cor 1:20

²⁰ For however many are the promises of God, in him is the “Yes.” Therefore also through him is the “Amen”, to the glory of God through us.

Jesus is God's “Yes” to every promise. In Him, we see God's reliability—steady, unfailing, unchanging.

Youth Reflection:

Which promise of God do you struggle to trust, and why?

Group Conversation Questions

- What do you learn about God's faithfulness from His covenant with Abraham?
- How does Jesus fulfill (not cancel) God's earlier promises?
- How does knowing God keeps His Word bring peace into your daily life?

Activity — Fill in the Blanks (Covenant Review)

1. A covenant is a sacred, _____ agreement God initiated.
2. God promised Abraham that all _____ on earth would be blessed.
3. Jesus' birth is the _____ of God's ancient promise.
4. God's promises stand because of His _____, not our perfection.

(Answers are in the Holiday YE Answer Key Appendix.)

Word Study

Covenant — “Berit” (בְּרִית): A binding, relational promise initiated by God.

Yahweh (יְהוָה): The covenant name of God; meaning “I AM,” the self-existent, eternal One.

To-Go Box

- God made a promise.
- God kept a promise.
- God still keeps His promises.
- When you cannot see the way forward, look backward at His faithfulness.

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for being a promise-keeping God. Help me trust Your covenant faithfulness in every season of life. Amen.”

Notes — Group Discussion & Personal Insight

Lesson 2 — The Cradle:

God Comes to Be with Us

Theme: God didn't stay distant—He moved in close.

Background Text: Isaiah 7:14; Matthew 1:18–25; Luke 2:1–7; John 1:1–14

Key Verse: John 1:14 (WEB)

“The Word became flesh and lived among us. We saw his glory, such glory as of the one and only Son of the Father, full of grace and truth.”

Appetizer – God in a Feeding Trough, Luke 2:7

“She gave birth to her firstborn son. She wrapped him in bands of cloth, and laid him in a feeding trough, because there was no room for them in the inn.”

Jesus didn't arrive in a palace. He arrived where animals ate, in a space that smelled like real life.

Youth Reflection:

The cradle shows us that God is not allergic to our real, messy situations.

Check-in (YES / NO):

Do you ever feel like your life is too messy for God to care about? YES / NO

Main Course

Bite 1 – Immanuel: God With Us, Matt 1:18, 23

¹⁸ Now the birth of Jesus Christ was like this: After his mother, Mary, was engaged to Joseph, before they came together, she was found pregnant by the Holy Spirit.

“Behold, the virgin shall be with child, and shall give birth to a son. They shall call his name Immanuel; which is, being interpreted, ‘God with us.’”

The Holy Spirit played an important part in Mary getting pregnant. Jesus is Immanuel — God with us, not just watching us. God didn't send a message; He sent Himself, by way of the Holy Spirit through Mary! He stepped into human skin, human pain, and human limitations. He knows what it feels like to be tired, rejected, misunderstood, and overlooked.

Reflection Question:

Where in your life do you most need to remember that God is actually *with* you, not just watching from a distance?

Bite 2 — He Became Flesh, John 1:14

¹⁴The Word became flesh and lived among us. We saw his glory, such glory as of the only born Son of the Father, full of grace and truth.

Like Father, like Son. Yes, he looked like us, that is the “currency” of Earth, but He carried the power of his father. There are examples of athletes who reminded us so much like their parents that they walked in that favor. Christ was similar in that He had all the power and the leverage of the “Great I am”, this was his entry point out of eternity into time.

Bite 3 — The Humble King, Phi 2:6–7

⁶who, existing in the form of God, didn’t consider equality with God a thing to be grasped, ⁷but emptied himself, taking the form of a servant, being made in the likeness of men. ⁸And being found in human form, he humbled himself

The Creator chose the crib before the crown. Before He carried the cross, He rested in a manger. This is the humility of Jesus — the King who starts His earthly story at the bottom, so no one can say He cannot relate to their struggle. He didn’t have a flashy life but was the son of a carpenter and did not flex his power to avoid the pain of life or death.

Israel was looking for a right now fix, but Christ’s vision shifted the outcome of forever!

Reflection Question:

How does seeing the cradle as the start of a rescue plan change how you look at Christmas?

Dessert – Intentional Savior, Micah 5:2

²But you, Bethlehem Ephrathah, being small among the clans of Judah, out of you one will come out to me who is to be ruler in Israel; whose goings out are from of old, from ancient times.

His birth was personal — *born to you*. The cradle reminds us that hope is not an idea; hope is a person. Our intentional Savior. Jesus was not an oops, by Mary -or was he the by-product of the milk man. Every time you see a nativity, remember: God is not far. God moved into the neighborhood.

To-Go Box

- Jesus didn't just come for "church people"—He came for real people.
- The cradle proves that God meets us in low places, not just high ones.
- Christmas is the celebration of God with us, not just gifts around us.

Activity – “Cradle Connections” (Matching)

Match the Scripture to the truth it highlights:

Truths

- A. God with us
- B. Jesus' humble birth
- C. Joseph trusts God
- D. The Word became flesh

Scripture References

- _____ John 1:14
- _____ Matthew 1:20–21
- _____ Isaiah 7:14
- _____ Luke 2:7

Directions: Draw lines or write the letter next to each reference.

(Answers are in the Holiday YE Answer Key Appendix.)

Check-In. Circle (YES / NO):

Do you honestly believe God understands what you feel? YES / NO

Do you struggle more with: **believing God is good** or **that God is near**? Circle one.

Notes / Takeaways:

Short Prayer

“Jesus, thank You for leaving heaven and stepping into a real, imperfect world.

Thank You that You understand what it feels like to be human.

Help me remember that You are with me in every season—high or low. In Your name, amen.”

Personal Prayer Space – Talk to Jesus About Where You Need Him Close

Lesson 3 — The Cross:

God Provides Salvation

Theme: The cross is where love paid the full price.

Background Text: Isaiah 53:4–6; John 3:16; John 19:17–30; 1 Peter 2:24; Romans 5:8

Key Verse: John 19:30 (WEB)

“When Jesus therefore had received the vinegar, he said, ‘It is finished.’ He bowed his head, and gave up his spirit.”

Appetizer – Why the Cross Matters, John 3:16

“For God so loved the world, that he gave his one and only Son, that whoever believes in him should not perish, but have eternal life.”

The cross is not just jewelry or a church logo. It is where love, justice, and mercy collided.

Youth Reflection:

The cradle matters because of the cross. Jesus didn’t just come to be born—He came to save.

Check-in (YES / NO):

When you think about the cross, do you feel more guilty or more grateful? YES / NO

Main Course

Bite 1 – He Carried What We Couldn’t, Isa 53:4–5

⁴ Surely he has borne our sicknesses and carried our sufferings; yet we considered him plagued, struck by God, and afflicted. ⁵ But he was pierced for our transgressions. He was crushed for our iniquities. The punishment that brought our peace was on him; and by his wounds we are healed.

Jesus carried:

Sin we couldn’t pay for.

Shame we couldn’t shake.

Wounds we couldn’t heal ourselves.

Reflection Question:

What is one burden you've tried to carry alone that you need to hand back to Jesus?

Bite 2 – Paid in Full, 1 Pet 2:24 (WEB, paraphrased)

²⁴ He himself bore our sins in his body on the tree, that we, having died to sins, might live to righteousness. You were healed by his wounds.

Atonement means Jesus paid the price for our sins. Salvation is not a reward for good behavior—it's a gift we receive by faith. The cross shows how serious sin is. The cross shows how deep God's love is.

“It is finished” means nothing else needs to be added.

Bite 3 – “It Is Finished”, Rom 5:8

⁸ But God commends his own love toward us, in that while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us.

When Jesus said, “It is finished,” He wasn't tapping out. He was declaring victory. The debt is paid. The curse is broken. The way back to God is open.

Youth Reflection:

You don't have to keep punishing yourself for what Jesus already paid for.

Check-in: (YES / NO)

Do you still feel like you have to “earn” God's love? YES / NO

Dessert – The End Justified the Means, Phil 2:8-10

(WEB) ⁸ And being found in human form, he humbled himself, becoming obedient to the point of death, yes, the death of the cross. ⁹ Therefore God also highly exalted him, and gave to him the name which is above every name, ¹⁰ that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, of those in heaven, those on earth, and those under the earth,

He didn't wait for you to “get yourself together.” He loved you mid-mess.

Check-In (YES / NO):

Do you believe Jesus died specifically for you, not just “for people”? YES / NO

Do you find it easier to forgive others than to forgive yourself? YES / NO

To-Go Box

- The cross is where love paid in full.
- Grace doesn't ignore sin; grace pays for it.
- You can stop trying to earn what Jesus already finished.

Activity – “Cross Connection” (Matching)

Terms

- A. Atonement
- B. Redemption
- C. Love
- D. “It is finished.”

Meanings

- _____ “Paid in full”; Jesus’ victory declaration
- _____ Being bought back by Christ
- _____ Jesus paying for our sins

(Match letter to number. Answer Key in YE and Instructor (IE) Appendix.)

Notes / Takeaways:

Short Prayer + Personal Prayer Space

Prayer

“Lord Jesus, thank You for the cross.
Thank You for paying for my sin, my shame, and my failures.
Teach me to live like ‘It is finished’ is true for me—
not just as a verse, but as my reality.
In Your name, amen.”

Personal Prayer – Thanking Jesus for the Cross

Lesson 4 — The Comforter:

God Remains with Us

Theme: The Holy Spirit is our Comforter, Advocate, and Teacher.

Background Text: John 14:16–18, 26; John 16:7–13; Romans 8:9–16; Galatians 5:22–23

Key Verse: John 14:26 (WEB)

“But the Counselor, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in my name, he will teach you all things, and will remind you of all that I said to you.”

Appetizer – Not Left Alone, John 14:16-18 (WEB)

¹⁶I will pray to the Father, and he will give you another Counselor, ^[a] that he may be with you forever: ¹⁷the Spirit of truth, whom the world can't receive, for it doesn't see him and doesn't know him. You know him, for he lives with you and will be in you.

Jesus told His followers He was leaving—but also that they would not be left alone. The Holy Spirit is God's promise that you are never truly abandoned.

Check-in (YES / NO):

Have you had a season recently where you felt spiritually alone? YES / NO

Main Course

Bite 1 – Wait, Help is One prayer Away, Acts 1:4,8 John 14:26

^{1:4} Being assembled together with them, he commanded them, “Don't depart from Jerusalem, but wait for the promise of the Father, which you heard from me. ⁸ But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you. You will be witnesses to me in Jerusalem, in all Judea and Samaria, and to the uttermost parts of the earth.”

^{14:26} But the Counselor, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in my name, he will teach you all things, and will remind you of all that I said to you.

Jesus prepares the disciples for His physical departure but promises “another Counselor.” “Another” means one of the same kind—someone who will continue His ministry, not cancel it. The Holy Spirit is not a lesser substitute; He is God's presence with and in believers, forever.

The Comforter (Counselor / Helper) is the Holy Spirit. He lives inside every believer. He guides, corrects, strengthens, and comforts.

Bite 2 – The Spirit Produces Power and Fruit, Gal 5:22–23

But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faith, gentleness, and self-control. Against such things there is no law.

The Spirit doesn't just give goosebumps; He grows fruit. Over time, His presence shows up as love instead of bitterness, peace instead of panic, and self-control instead of out-of-control reactions. The real evidence that the Comforter is with us is not just how we feel but how we live.

The Spirit produces fruit: **attributes or character traits** that show you are His (or connected to your Heavenly Father.) The Comforter changes how we respond to stress, conflict, and pressure.

Reflection Question:

Which part of the Spirit's fruit do you need most in this season—and why?

Bite 3 – Help in Our Weakness, Rom 8:26-27

“In the same way, the Spirit also helps our weaknesses, for we don't know how to pray as we ought. But the Spirit himself makes intercession for us with groanings which can't be uttered.”
He who searches the hearts knows what is on the Spirit's mind, because he makes intercession for the saints according to God.

He grows character, not just feelings. The Spirit's presence is not just to comfort us in private; it empowers us in public. When the Holy Spirit comes, timid believers become bold witnesses. Comfort doesn't mean an escape from assignment—often it means strength for the assignment.

The Comforter gives you power to say no to what destroys you. He gives you courage to do what God asks—even when it's hard. He reminds you of what Jesus said when your mind is cluttered.

Author's Testimony

I was going through “Battle Stations” while in Navy Bootcamp and we had to go on one part of the course in gas masks and protective gear. It felt suffocating and uncomfortable and to make it more challenging we were given a 150lbs dummy that we had to push and pull up a rope the height of one story! The recruit that was ahead of me wanted to give up. So, I had the weight of her and the dummy pressing down on me while I held on with all that I had. I pleaded to God for help and tried to encourage her not to quit! My mind wanted to not to quit but my body was pushed to its limits...

Sometimes the weight of the world (figuratively) bears down on you. Your body is tired, emotionally you are spent but you must embrace His strength in your weakness to make it through.

Check-in (YES / NO):

Do you feel like you understand who the Holy Spirit is? YES / NO

Dessert – Intercessor, You’re Not Alone, John 16:13

¹³ However, when he, the Spirit of truth, has come, he will guide you into all truth, for he will not speak from himself; but whatever he hears, he will speak. He will declare to you things that are coming.

Before Artificial Intelligence (AI) or SIRI, Alexa and _____, the Holy Spirit was. Our weakness is not a barrier to God’s work—it is often the very place where the Comforter works most deeply. Programs can fail you; codes do ‘break’ overtime. The Holy Spirit is your GPS when your eternal battery feels low, when your knees feel weak, and self-restraint is all but gone. He’s the reason why the phone rings, or the zipper gets stuck, or the car horn blares. Even when the loan keeps getting denied. Sometimes we can’t walk away so he allows the thing that is tearing at you to grow legs. His guidance helps us to avoid bigger heartache, financial ruin, or physical trauma that we can’t see in the moment. All truth is not cute, but it is to provide you with the tools to lead a purposeful life, in and with Him.

The Comforter means God is not just with you—He is in you.

To-Go Box

- You are not walking this faith journey alone.
- The Holy Spirit is your Helper, Teacher, and Comforter.
- His presence produces real change from the inside out.

One sentence summary:

The same God who made the covenant, came in the cradle, and died on the cross now lives inside you by His Spirit.

Check-In (YES / NO):

“Do you feel like you really understand who the Holy Spirit is? YES / NO”

(Why or why not?)

Short Prayer

“Holy Spirit, thank You for being my Comforter and Helper. Fill me again with Your presence. Grow Your fruit in my life—love, joy, peace, and all the rest. Help me remember I am never alone when You are with me. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Notes / Takeaways:

THE DIVINE NAMES: TIMES & SEASONS

A Spiritual Journey Through God's Names



Introduction for Bonus Content

In church, we sing and shout about **Jehovah Jireh, Jehovah Shalom, Elohim, and El Shaddai**—but sometimes we don’t slow down long enough to ask, “*Okay... what does that actually mean for my life?*” This Youth Bonus “Bible Basics” section is designed to help you connect the dots: the **names of God**, the meaning behind **numbers** like 3, 7, and 40, and how God works through **times and seasons**—because God isn’t only for Sundays, and His Word isn’t only for grown-ups.

God is not distant and generic; He is personal and specific. Think about it like this: the same person can be called “Mom,” “Nana,” “Auntie,” “Best Friend,” or “Boss” depending on the relationship. Same person—different roles, different levels of closeness. In the same way, God reveals Himself through different names because He meets us in different moments: when you need peace, when you need direction, when you need strength, when you need help. The more you walk with Him, the more you learn how to call Him by what He has already been in your life.

Lesson 1: Names of God

You’ll learn what God’s names mean and why they matter—so your prayers stop sounding random and start sounding confident. This lesson helps you recognize how God shows up (peace, provision, healing, guidance) and reminds you: He’s not far... He’s faithful.

Lesson 2: Numbers, Times and Seasons

This lesson connects the “counting” language in scripture to real life—because wisdom isn’t just knowing *what* time it is, but knowing *what to do* with it. You’ll explore what numbers like **3, 7, 12, and 40** often point to, and how God uses seasons (waiting, growth, pruning, breakthrough) to shape you on purpose—one day at a time.

God is about relationship, not just ritual. So, here’s the challenge: *What do you think is true about God—and what does the Truth say?* These lessons are an invitation to move past a “God, fix it!” moment and into a real conversation with your Heavenly Father. He hears. He sees. He knows. As you explore His names and His timing—and what numbers often symbolize along the way—take notes, ask questions, look up the scriptures, and keep turning the page—because God isn’t trying to impress you; He’s trying to **meet** you.

Lesson 5: The Names of God:

Understanding the Sacred Language

Theme: Foundations of Faith

Background Text: Exodus 3:13–15; Isaiah 9:6; John 1:1–3; Isaiah 48:17

Key Verse: Exodus 3:14 (WEB)

¹⁴ God said to Moses, “I AM WHO I AM,” and he said, “You shall tell the children of Israel this: ‘I AM has sent me to you.’”

Appetizer – A Sacred Introduction

The names of God are not random titles — they reveal His identity, power, and relationship with His people. Ancient Hebrews viewed the name of God as so holy that it was never spoken aloud. Instead, they used *Adonai* (Lord) or wrote *G-d* — omitting the vowel to honor His sacredness.

Youth Reflection → How do you show reverence when speaking about or to God?

Main Course – Understanding the Divine Names and Titles

Bite 1 – YHWH (יהוה) – The Self-Existent One, Ex 3:14–15

God said to Moses, “I AM WHO I AM,” and he said, “You shall tell the children of Israel this: ‘I AM has sent me to you.’” God said moreover to Moses, “You shall tell the children of Israel this, ‘Yahweh, the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, has sent me to you.’ This is my name forever, and this is my memorial to all generations.”

The personal name God revealed to Moses is represented by the four Hebrew letters *Yod-Hey-Vav-Hey* (YHWH).

In Hebrew, God’s personal name is written with four letters: Y-H-W-H (יהוה), often called the Tetragrammaton. Ancient Hebrew writing left out vowels, so over time people stopped saying this name out loud and read “Adonai” (“Lord”) instead. Later, scholars combined the consonants YHWH with the vowels from “Adonai,” and as the name passed through Latin into English, letters shifted—Y became J, and W was written as V—so the form “Jehovah” appeared in older Bibles. Today many scholars think the original pronunciation sounded more like “Yahweh,” but the key point is that God chose to share a personal name, showing He is not just a distant power but a God who wants to be known.

Bite 2 – Yeshua HaMashiach (יֵשׁוּעַ הַמָּשִׁיחַ), Matt 1:21(WEB)

“²¹ She shall give birth to a son. You shall name him Jesus, for it is he who shall save his people from their sins.”

Yeshua means “Yahweh saves.” The English “Jesus Christ” is really “Jesus the Christ” — or Yeshua the Anointed One. “Christ” (Christos) and “Messiah” (Mashiach) are the same title in two languages — both mean “Anointed.”

Youth Reflection → Does understanding His Hebrew name deepen your faith in His mission?

Bite 3 – Ruach HaKodesh (רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ) – The Holy Spirit, Ps 51:11 (WEB)

Don’t throw me from your presence, and don’t take your Holy Spirit from me.

Literally “The Holy Breath.”

The word Ruach means “breath,” “wind,” or “spirit.” It signifies the living presence of God breathing life, comfort, and conviction into His people.

Youth Reflection → What areas of your life need the fresh wind of the Holy Spirit?

Bite 4 – YHWH Lammēd (יְהוָה לָמֵד) – The Lord Our Teacher, Isaiah 48:17

Yahweh, your Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel, says: “I am Yahweh your God, who teaches you to profit, who leads you by the way that you should go...”

God is not only Savior but Teacher — revealing truth line upon line and leading us to wisdom.

Bite 5 – Selah (סֵלָה), Reflect, Ps 3:4

(WEB) I cry to Yahweh with my voice, and he answers me out of his holy hill. Selah.

Found 74 times in the Psalms, Selah means “pause and reflect.” It’s a divine rest stop — a spiritual breath meant for meditation.

Bite 6 – Amen (אָמֵן), 2 Cor 1:20

²⁰ For however many are the promises of God, in him is the “Yes.” Therefore also through him is the “Amen”, to the glory of God through us.

From aman — “to confirm, to be faithful.”

When we say “Amen,” we declare “Let it be so” — aligning our agreement with God’s word.

Bite 7 – Hallelujah (הַלְלִי-יָהּ), Ps 150:1

Praise Yah! Praise God in his sanctuary! Praise him in his heavens for his acts of power!

A compound of *Hallel* (praise) + *Yah* (short for YHWH). Meaning “Praise the Lord!” — it is the same in nearly every language, uniting all believers in worship.

Bite 8 – The True Vine, John 15:1

“I am the true vine, and my Father is the farmer.”

Yeshua identifies Himself as the source of life — the one through whom believers bear fruit.

Bite 9 – The Son of God, Matt 16:16

“You are the Messiah, the Son of the living God.”

This title declares both His divinity and His relationship with the Father.

Dessert –What you need– He is, Isaiah 9:6

⁶For a child is born to us. A son is given to us; and the government will be on his shoulders. His name will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace.

No matter how He is named — YHWH, Yeshua, Ruach HaKodesh, or Abba — His nature remains one: holy, eternal, and faithful.

Group Reflection → Which name of God speaks most to your current need or revelation?

Word Study

Term	Language	Meaning
YHWH (יהוה)	Hebrew	“I AM” – Self-existent One
Yeshua (ישוע)	Hebrew / Aramaic	Yahweh Saves
Ruach HaKodesh (רוח הקדש)	Hebrew	Holy Spirit / Breath of God
YHWH Lammēd (יהוה למד)	Hebrew	The Lord Our Teacher
Selah (סֶלָה)	Hebrew	Pause and Reflect
Amen (אָמֵן)	Hebrew	Let It Be So / Truly
Hallelujah (הללוֹיָהּ)	Hebrew	Praise the Lord
Abba (אָבָא)	Aramaic	Father / Intimate One
Mashiach (מָשִׁיחַ)	Hebrew	Anointed One
Emmanuel (עִמָּנוּאֵל)	Hebrew	God With Us

Historical Sidebar

(Tetra – what? Def: the Hebrew name of God [transliterated](#) in four letters as **YHWH** or **JHVH** and [articulated](#) as **Yahweh** or **Jehovah**)

Language Stage	Rendering of Jesus’ Name	Approx. Century
Hebrew	Yeshua (ישוע)	Before 1st Century
Greek	Iesous (Ἰησοῦς)	1st Century
Latin	Iesus	4th Century
English	Jesus	16th Century

The letter *J* evolved from the letter *I*, first appearing in print around 1524. Jewish scribes avoided writing God’s full name to prevent misuse — hence *G-d*.

Group/Personal Reflection Questions

- Why is God’s name written as *G-d* or *YHWH* in Hebrew tradition?
- How does *Yeshua HaMashiach* deepen your understanding of salvation?
- What does *Ruach HaKodesh* reveal about God’s closeness to His people?

To-Go Box

- How you refer to a person can change as you get closer together
- YHWH, Adonai, Savior, Elohim – becomes more the deeper your relation is to the Lover or your and Creator of all things
- Challenge yourself weekly to dedicate seeing God as more than the “man upstairs” but as your Lord and your friend

Author's Testimony

A lady I met in church befriended me when attending our family church, Antioch Holiness Church, in Cross, SC. My grandma, Pearl was battling breast cancer, and Sis Shepherd felt inspired to invite me to a teens Christian youth camp. We drove to Raliegh/Durham area, and I had the opportunity to fellowship with girls 12-17 years old at a weekend sleepover. The youth counselors showed us that God can use our faith to perform miracles!

People whose limbs were short, became lengthened, folks dealing with pain was healed. We laid hands and saw Jehovah Jirreh, at work! The I Am, that I Am just needed our faith. Your age, your gender, or social status are not roadblocks for the move of God, it's your level of faith, and the absence of doubt.

Bonus Lesson — Times & Seasons:

God’s Order in Days and Numbers

Theme: Foundations of Faith

Background Text: Genesis 1:14–19; Genesis 8:22; Leviticus 25:8–13

Key Verse: Ecclesiastes 3:1 (WEB)

“For everything there is a season, and a time for every purpose under heaven.”

Appetizer – The Rhythm of the Kingdom

God is a God of order, and the way He measures time is deeply spiritual. The same God who created oceans and galaxies also created schedules, seasons, and rhythms—because life works better when it follows His design.

In Genesis, God said the sun and moon were made for “signs and seasons” (appointed times). When God delivered Israel from Egypt, He even reset their calendar—teaching them that deliverance is not just an event; it’s a new beginning. When we learn God’s patterns, we stop guessing about our lives and start paying attention to what He’s doing in our season.

Main Course

Bite 1 — God’s Order in Numbers

God is intentional down to the details—down to the hairs on your head. If He cares about the small things, it makes sense that numbers in Scripture often carry patterns and meaning. These patterns don’t replace the Word; they help us notice God’s fingerprints in the story.

Number	Meaning	Scripture Example
1	Unity; Beginning	Deuteronomy 6:4
2	Witness; Agreement	Matthew 18:19
3	Divine Completeness	Matthew 28:19
4	Creation; Divine Order	Revelation 7:1
5	Grace	Genesis 43:34
6	Man; Labor	Revelation 13:18
7	Perfection; Rest	Genesis 2:2
8	New Beginnings	2 Peter 2:5
9	Fruitfulness; Judgment	Galatians 5:22

10	Law; Responsibility	Exodus 20:1–17
12	Government; Authority	Revelation 21:12
40	Testing / Transition	Matthew 4:2
50	Jubilee; Freedom	Leviticus 25:10

Youth Thought: God uses numbers and patterns to show us that He is intentional about the details of our lives. Your current “wait” may actually be a “40-day” preparation for your “8th-day” new beginning.

Bite 2 — Calendar & Seasons

In Western culture, we often think of a day as sunrise to sunrise. In biblical Jewish culture, a day is often counted from sunset to sunset. That’s why many Jewish holidays begin at sundown. It’s a reminder that God can start something new in what looks like “night.”

Associating biblical times, seasons, and celebrations with our calendar helps bring the Word to life—because God is not only the God of “back then,” but the God of right now. As you look at the months and cycles, notice how God keeps repeating the same message: freedom, formation, repentance, and renewal.

Jewish Month	Gregorian Equivalent	Primary Focus / Festival
1. Nisan	March / April	Passover, Unleavened Bread, Firstfruits
2. Iyar	April / May	Counting the Omer
3. Sivan	May / June	Shavuot (Pentecost / Giving of the Law)
4. Tammuz	June / July	Fast of the 17th of Tammuz
5. Av	July / August	Tisha B'Av (Temple remembrance)
6. Elul	August / September	Repentance / Preparation for Rosh Hashanah
7. Tishrei	September / October	Rosh Hashanah, Yom Kippur, Sukkot
8. Cheshvan	October / November	A “quiet” month (no major feasts)
9. Kislev	November / December	Hanukkah (Feast of Dedication)
10. Tevet	December / January	Fast of the 10th of Tevet
11. Shevat	January / February	Tu B'Shevat (New Year for Trees)
12. Adar	February / March	Purim (Esther’s victory)

Note: Tishrei (September/October) begins the civil year with Rosh Hashanah. In some leap years on the Hebrew calendar, an extra month is added to keep the lunar cycle aligned with the solar seasons.

Season (Cycle)	Key Holidays / Observances	Scripture Reference (examples)
Spring: Redemption	Passover + Unleavened Bread	Exodus 12; Leviticus 23
Late Spring / Early Summer: Covenant & Harvest	Shavuot (Feast of Weeks)	Leviticus 23; Deuteronomy 16
Summer: Reflection	A season of reflection and remembrance	Psalms 90:12 ("count our days")
Fall: Repentance & Ingathering	Trumpets / Atonement / Tabernacles themes	Leviticus 23
Winter: Dedication / Light	Feast of Dedication (Hanukkah) themes	John 10:22
Late Winter / Early Spring: Turning / Joy	Purim (deliverance)	Esther 9
Land-Cycle (multi-year)	Sabbath year & Jubilee patterns	Leviticus 25

Youth Thought: Every number and every month can become a reminder that God is intentional. When we see the patterns, we stop guessing about our lives and start governing our choices with wisdom and prayer.

Reflection

In looking at seasons—and what you now know about different calendars—what stands out to you, and how could it change the way you pray or plan your next steps?

Dessert — The Year of Jubilee, Leviticus 25:10 (WEB)

“You shall make the fiftieth year holy, and proclaim liberty throughout the land to all its inhabitants. It shall be a jubilee to you...”

God’s timing is designed to lead to freedom, not fatigue. Jubilee was a reset—debts canceled, land restored, and people released. It was a real-life picture of God’s heart: restoration over defeat.

Youth Reflection: Where do you need God to “reset” something in your life—your mind, your habits, your schedule, or your hope?

To-Go Box

- Seasons are temporary; God’s purpose is eternal.
- God’s timing is designed to produce freedom, not exhaustion.
- Pay attention to the patterns—God often speaks through the rhythm of your life.

Word Study

Mo’ed (Hebrew) – An appointed time, season, or festival.

Activity – Times & Seasons Check (YE)

Part A – Match the Number

Match each number to its common biblical theme:

- A. 7 ___ Completion / rest
- B. 8 ___ New beginnings
- C. 12 ___ Government / authority
- D. 40 ___ Testing / transition
- E. 50 ___ Jubilee / freedom

(Answers are in the Holiday YE Answer Key Appendix.)

Part B – Short Answer

1) What does Mo'ed mean?

2) What does Shabbat mean?

3) In your own words, what is Jubilee (Leviticus 25), and what does it show us about God?

Part C – Multiple Choice

In Genesis 1:14, God said the lights in the sky were created for:

- a) Just decoration
- b) Signs and seasons, days and years
- c) To control people's moods
- d) None of the above

Part D – Personal Check-In

Which “season” word (planting, waiting, pruning, harvest) describes you right now, and why?

Prayer

“Lord, thank You that my times are in Your hands. Thank You that You are a God of order, purpose, and perfect timing. Help me recognize what You’re doing in this season and respond with wisdom. Amen.”



Bonus Games — Review & Fun

These games help you review all six lessons in a fun way. Keep your Bible nearby, work solo or with a team, and collect stamps as you go.

Game 1 — HOL Passport Challenge (Stamp Race)

Time: 15–25 minutes | Players: 1–6 (solo or teams) | Goal: earn all 6 stamps.

How it works: complete each challenge. When you finish, fill in the stamp box for that lesson.

THE COVENANT Stamp: _____	THE CRADLE Stamp: _____	THE CROSS Stamp: _____
THE COMFORTER Stamp: _____	NAMES OF GOD Stamp: _____	TIMES & SEASONS Stamp: _____

Challenges (complete all 6):

1. **Covenant:** Read Genesis 12:1–3. In 1–2 sentences: What promise did God make, and what does it teach you about God’s faithfulness?

2. **Cradle:** Read Luke 2:7 and Matthew 1:23. In 1 sentence: What does “Immanuel” mean, and why does it matter?

3. **Cross:** Read John 3:16 and Romans 5:8. In 1–2 sentences: What did Jesus do for us, and what should our response be?

4. **Comforter:** Read John 14:18 and Acts 1:8. Name one way the Holy Spirit helps believers, and one “fruit” you want God to grow in you (Galatians 5:22–23).

5. **Names of God:** Choose one name/title from the lesson (YHWH, Yeshua, Ruach HaKodesh, Abba, etc.). Write: When I feel _____, God is _____ because _____.

6. **Numbers, Times & Seasons:** Read Ecclesiastes 3:1 and Psalm 90:12 (“count our days”). Choose a season word (planting, waiting, pruning, harvest) and write one wise step you can take this week.

Team/Player Name: _____

THE COVENANT Stamp: _____	THE CRADLE Stamp: _____ 	THE CROSS Stamp: _____
THE COMFORTER Stamp: _____	NAMES OF GOD Stamp: _____	TIMES & SEASONS Stamp: _____

Team/Player Name: _____

THE COVENANT Stamp: _____	THE CRADLE Stamp: _____ 	THE CROSS Stamp: _____
THE COMFORTER Stamp: _____	NAMES OF GOD Stamp: _____	TIMES & SEASONS Stamp: _____

(Make copies for game play)



Master Tracker (PTG)



Stamp Tracker (Keep track of players/Team's progression):

Category	Level 1			Level 2			Level 3		
COV — Covenant	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRA — Cradle	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRO — Cross	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
COM — Comforter	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
NOG — Names of God	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
TS —	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Numbers/Times/Seasons									

Stamp Tracker (mark levels earned):

Category	Level 1			Level 2			Level 3		
COV — Covenant	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRA — Cradle	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRO — Cross	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
COM — Comforter	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
NOG — Names of God	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
TS —	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Numbers/Times/Seasons									

Stamp Tracker Name:

Category	Level 1			Level 2			Level 3		
COV — Covenant	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRA — Cradle	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRO — Cross	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
COM — Comforter	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
NOG — Names of God	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
TS —	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Numbers/Times/Seasons									

Holiday Edition – YE Activity Answer Key Appendix

Use this appendix for grading, prep, or quick reference.

Reflection questions and open-ended activities do not have fixed “right” answers.

Lesson 1 — THE COVENANT (YE)

Activity – Fill in the Blanks

1. A covenant is a sacred, binding agreement God started.
 2. God promised that all families on earth would be blessed through Abraham.
 3. Jesus’ birth is the fulfillment of God’s ancient promise.
 4. God’s promises stand because of His faithfulness, not our perfection.
-

Lesson 2 — THE CRADLE (YE)

Activity – “Cradle Connections” (Matching)

- John 1:14 → D. The Word became flesh
 - Matthew 1:20–21 → C. Joseph trusts God
 - Isaiah 7:14 → A. God with us (Immanuel)
 - Luke 2:7 → B. Jesus’ humble birth
-

Lesson 3 — THE CROSS (YE)

Activity – “Cross Connection” (Matching)

Terms → Meanings

- A. Atonement → 3. Jesus paying for our sins
 - B. Redemption → 2. Being bought back by Christ
 - C. Love → 4. God’s motivation for the cross
 - D. “It is finished.” → 1. “Paid in full”; Jesus’ victory declaration
-

Lesson 4 — THE COMFORTER (YE)

Activity – “Comfort Letters”

- This is a creative, reflection-based activity.

- Evaluate by:
 - Sincerity and thoughtfulness
 - Connection to lesson truths about the Holy Spirit (Comforter / Helper / Guide)
 - Use of Scripture where applicable
 - There is no single correct wording.
-

Bonus Lesson — Youth Names of God (Answer Key)

Activity 1 – Fill in the Blank

1. There is no letter J in the Hebrew alphabet.
2. The name Yeshua means “Yahweh saves.”
3. The Holy Spirit in Hebrew is called “Ruach HaKodesh.”
4. Selah means “pause and reflect.”
5. Amen means “Let it be so” (or “truly”).

Activity 2 – Name Match

- YHWH → “I AM” / Self-Existent One / covenant name of God
- Hallelujah → “Praise the Lord”
- Emmanuel → “God with us”
- Abba → “Father” / intimate, close term

Activity 3 – True / False

- a) “Christ” and “Messiah” both mean “Anointed One.” → True
 - b) Ruach HaKodesh means “God with us.” → False (It means “Holy Spirit / Holy Breath.”)
-

Bonus Lesson — TIMES & SEASONS (Answer Key)

Activity – Times & Seasons Check (YE) — Answer Key

- Part A – Match the Number
- 7 → Completion / rest

- 8 → New beginnings
- 12 → Government / authority

40 → Testing / transition

50 → Jubilee / freedom

Part B – Short Answer

Mo'ed → an appointed time / season

Shabbat → rest (Sabbath)

Jubilee → a reset: liberty + restoration (Leviticus 25)

Part C – Multiple Choice: Genesis 1:14 → b) Signs and seasons, days and years (Part D: personal response)

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- Kossi Bruno, *A Friend*, (2019)

Wellness Support Team

Charleston Wellness Center – thank you for reminding us that spiritual work flourishes best when mind, body, and soul are cared for together.

Editors

To my editors – including the gifted freelancers who labored behind their online pen names – thank you for your attentive eyes, patient revisions, and for helping me carry the heart of this message with clarity and excellence. Your quiet, faithful work is felt on every page.

Reference & Study Resources

Historical, linguistic, and cultural insights for the instructors and teachers- extended study materials have been formed by standard biblical reference works, concordances, and reputable academic sources, as outlined in the Reference & Historical Source Index (Instructor Edition) for this series. These tools were used under educational Fair Use to provide context, clarity, and enrichment for teachers and students alike.

FaithTech & Digital Tools

Special thanks to the emerging world of FaithTech and “greater works” digital tools that helped make this project possible at a fraction of the traditional cost, multiplying reach while honoring the message of the Gospel.

Above all, I give glory to God for every person, prayer, tool, and resource that has helped turn Soul Food from a vision into a living, teaching ministry on the page.

Why Soul Food?



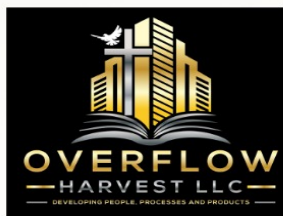
Evang. Rose Doctor,
Soul Food Team

Food brings people together—especially young people. If there’s a free meal or snacks, you can count on a crowd. Food comforts, fuels, and sustains our bodies. In the same way, Soul Food is designed to feed and strengthen our spirit.

The **Soul Food Holiday Youth Edition** helps teens and young adults dig into God’s Word in bite-sized, real-life ways. It’s a tool for spiritual growth and everyday battles—a way to stay rooted in Christ while facing peer pressure, social media, and the ups and downs of life. Families and youth leaders can use it to build a strong foundation, spark honest conversations, and draw this generation closer to their Creator.

With interactive lessons, reflection prompts, and fun Bible knowledge challenges, this workbook series turns “just another study” into a shared experience. It’s perfect for youth groups, family nights, or friends who want to grow in faith together and create lasting memories.

In a world where people scroll more than they talk, Soul Food gives youth a reason to gather, open their Bibles, and encounter Immanuel—“God with us.” Soul Food Youth Holiday Edition is a must-have.



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